

My (Chiffon) Nguyen

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Current and future AI that are socially responsible and beneficial for diverse groups of humans and social contexts

- **AI alignment** (value alignment, pluralistic alignment, OOD generalization, multi-agent systems)
- **multilingual and multicultural AI**, focusing on language, speech, and vision-language models
- **human-AI collaboration & socially aware AI** grounded in social science, Human-Computer Interaction research

EDUCATION

Minerva University, College of Computational Sciences

Sep 2021 – May 2025

B.Sc in Computational Sciences (Machine Learning and Statistics), GPA: 3.7/4.0

San Francisco, CA, USA

- **Relevant Coursework:** Machine Learning (A), Bayesian Modeling (A), Statistical Modeling and Causal Inference (A), Optimization Methods (A), Probability and Statistics (A-)
- **Global Experience:** Seoul (South Korea), Taipei, Hyderabad (India), Buenos Aires (Argentina), Berlin (Germany)

SELECTED PUBLICATION

P=Preprint, R=Under Review, J=Journal, C=Conference, W=Workshop. Full publication list on [Google Scholar](https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=MyChiffon).

- [R1] **SEATauBench: Adapting Tool-Agent-User Evaluation Into Low-Resource Southeast Asian Languages**
My Chiffon Nguyen*, Aulia Adila*, Saksorn Ruangtanusak*, Kittiphat Leesombatwathana*, Vissuta Gunawan Lim*, Patomporn Payoungkhamdee, Samuel Cahyawijaya
In submission for EMNLP, 2026.

- [P1] [Anthropogenic Regional Adaptation in Multimodal Vision-Language Model](#)
Samuel Cahyawijaya, Peerat Limkonchotiwat, Tack Hwa Wong, et al. (including My Chiffon Nguyen)
Preprint, 2026.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Intern (AI Safety)

Jun 2026 – Present

Lida Safety Research

Remote

- Contributing to three projects in persona alignment, scalable oversight, and sandbagging
- Mentors: [Linh Le](#) (MILA Postdoc) and [David Williams-King](#) (ERA:AI Research Manager)

Research Analysis Subteam Lead (Multi-cultural Reasoning Evaluation)

May 2026 – Present

Cohere Labs Open Science Community

Remote

- Co-leading a team of 15 community researchers analyzing LLM behavior on multi-cultural riddles, with a focus on factual accuracy, hallucination behavior, topic level patterns, and cross culture model reasoning
- Collaborating with Cohere Labs researcher [Julia Kreutzer](#) and six team leads to coordinate model benchmarking and human evaluation workflows, and synthesize findings for open science outputs, including datasets, posts, and publication

AI Research Mentee (Multilingual Agentic Evaluation)

Feb 2026 – Jun 2026

SEACrowd, SEACrowd 2026 Research Apprenticeship

Remote

- Stress-testing [Tau2-Bench](#), which benchmarks Tool-Agent-User interaction in real-world domains, across shifts in language and local cultural contexts
- Mentors: [Dr. Samuel Cahyawijaya](#) (Cohere Labs) and [Patomporn Payoungkhamdee](#) (VISTEC Thailand)

AI Research Lead Mentee (Chain-of-thought Monitoring)

Oct 2025 – Jun 2026

AlgoVerse AI Research, AI Research Program Fall 2025 (Mentor: [Yeonwoo Jang \(MATS 8.2\)](#))

Remote

- Investigating whether weaker AI models can **detect sandbagging** (deliberate underperformance) in stronger models on safety-critical evaluations [\[Code\]](#)
- Designed end-to-end monitoring pipeline (Inspect AI + Inspect Scout) and evaluated monitoring success rates across 30+ pairs of reasoning models (Qwen3.5, Deepseek V4, Gemma4, GPT-OSS)

Applied Machine Learning Research Intern (3D Object Detection Application)

Jun – Aug 2024

Landshut University of Applied Sciences, AI & Mixed Reality Lab

Landshut, Bavaria, Germany

- Supervisors: [Prof. Eduard Kromer](#) and [Prof. Sandra Eisenreich](#)

TEACHING & MENTORING EXPERIENCE

Curious Cardinals, AI & Data Science, Mentor

Nov 2025 – Present

- Mentoring a project about robustness of fact-checking language models under evidence corruption and language shifts

Minerva University, *PR51 Programming with Python*, Lead Tutor

Spring 2025

- Taught 40+ first-year students from 20+ countries in **weekly hands-on programming labs** for 11 weeks, covering Python, OOP, debugging, security, and computing fundamentals
- Analyzed student performance data and tutor surveys across 11 weeks to identify 12 learning bottlenecks, improving engagement metrics by 15% for the next cohort

Minerva University, *FA50/FA51 Logic, Probability & Statistics*, Lead Teaching Assistant

Fall 2022 – Spring 2024

- Supported **150+ students each semester** per semester in formal logic, probability and statistics, algorithmic thinking, and simulation, through weekly office hours
- Provided **formative assessment on 25 semesterly quizzes** for 50 students to correct and shape their learning
- Assisted professors in **grading** three semesterly math and programming assignments

SELECTED PROJECTS

Mnemonic Generation for Vocabulary Learning (github.com/mychiffonn/mnemonic-gen)

Oct 2024 – Mar 2025

- Designed an AI chatbot that generated diverse, memorable, and linguistically-grounded mnemonic devices for learning English and Mandarin Chinese vocabulary
- Utilized chain-of-thought distillation from a teacher model (DeepSeekR1) to instill linguistic chain-of-thought reasoning to a student model (Gemma3-1b) through **supervised fine-tuning (QLoRA)** with unsloth
- Implemented a **Direct Preference Optimization (DPO)** pipeline through trl for preference modeling on Gemma3-1b using 500 human and LLM-annotated preference pairs (on memorability, imageability, and retention rates)

Replication: Synthetic Control (Causal Inference) (github.com/mychiffonn/synthetic-control-rep)

Dec 2023

- Replicated [Chrisinger \(2021\)](#)'s synthetic control analysis of Philadelphia's SNAP benefit redemption in R, analyzing policy impacts across 4 counties and 50+ months of longitudinal data
- Extended analysis with leave-one-out robustness analysis, revealing original donor pool sensitivity and model instability

OPEN SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS

[SEACrowd](#) Website Designer & Maintainer

Aug 2025 – Present

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming Languages:** Python, SQL, Bash, TypeScript, R
- **Machine Learning:** PyTorch, scikit-learn, unsloth, trl, Inspect AI, LangGraph, LlamaIndex, harbor, benchflow
- **Web/App Development:** Astro, React, FastAPI, Express.js, PostgreSQL, TailwindCSS, shadcn/ui
- **Tools & DevOps:** Git, Docker, Python tooling (uv, ruff, ty), LaTeX, Zotero

LANGUAGES

Vietnamese (native), English (fluent/C1), Mandarin Chinese (lower-intermediate/B1/HSK 4)

CERTIFICATES

- **Tiny Aya Expedition**, Cohere Labs (credsverse.com/credentials/0e262642-a662-4d2b-ac4e-8ca35fc2f80c) Mar 2026
- **Advanced Web Development**, CodePath (drive.google.com/file/d/1n4dHj4TFM8HWIDXMTt9ZGjEXVIpkP-F-/view)
- **Natural Language Specialization**, deeplearning.ai (coursera.org/verify/specialization/3FJ3W7QJX8GK) Nov 2023
- **Machine Learning Specialization**, deeplearning.ai (coursera.org/verify/specialization/G9898XKB9EAV) Jun 2022

Last Updated: Jun 08, 2026